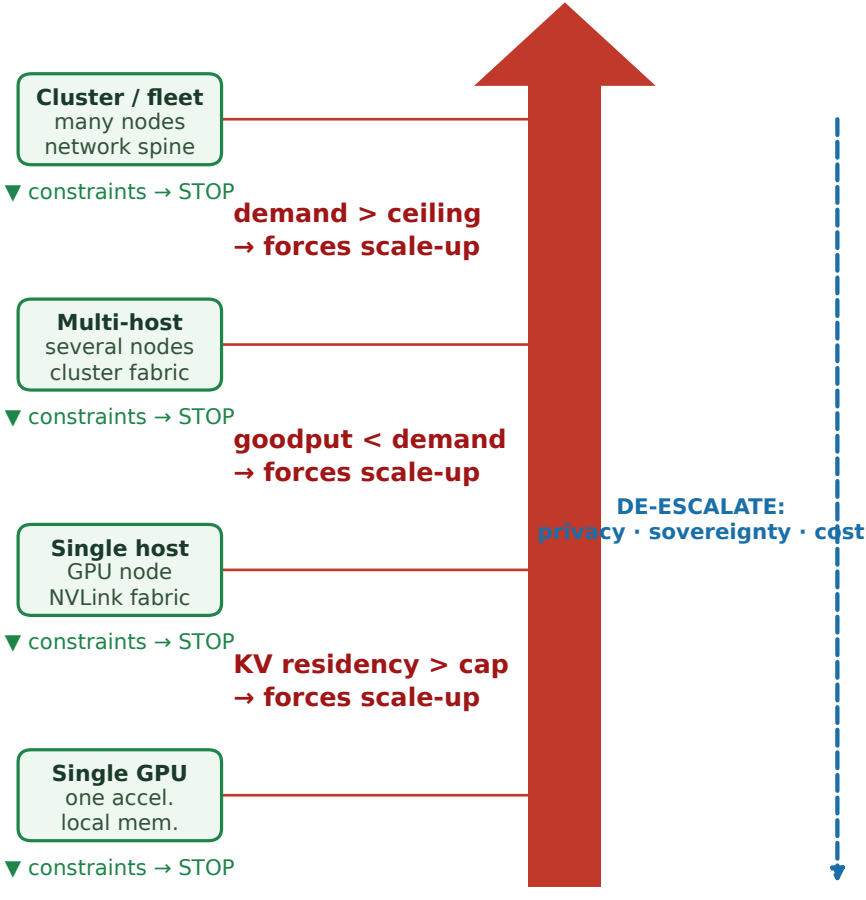
The reference-architecture escalation ladder



escalate only when a constraint binds — else STOP; tiers are distinct levels of scale, not a quality ranking